

FILM DOSSIER: CAPTAIN AMERICA: REBORN

Phase 5 · Film #7 (Saga Two, Film #16 · Overall Film #45)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

1. IDENTITY

Field	Entry
Film #	Saga Two #16 (Phase 5, Film #7) · MCU #45
Phase	Phase 5, The Secret Wars Saga : "Time Runs Out"
Real title	<i>CAPTAIN AMERICA: REBORN</i> (the name of the 616 storyline)
Decoy / codename title	" <i>SUNRISE</i> "
Release date	Friday, March 5, 2027 , the week of the 20th anniversary of <i>Captain America</i> #25 (on sale Wednesday, March 7, 2007), the issue in which Steve Rogers is shot
Distributor	Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures
Director	Julius Onah
Rating / runtime	PG-13 · 162 minutes
Genre + second genre	Superhero action-adventure + political assassination thriller / time-slip war film

2. OWNERSHIP

Field	Entry
Whose film / franchise is this?	TYRESE AVERY (Captain America, film 4 of the franchise). Sebastian Stan is billed second as the new Captain America .

Character	Actor	Age at release
Steve Rogers / Captain America	Tyrese Avery	45
Bucky Barnes / The Winter Soldier → Captain America	Sebastian Stan	44
Sam Wilson / The Falcon	Anthony Mackie	48
Sharon Carter / Agent 13	Emily VanCamp	40
Natasha Romanoff / Black Widow	Harmony Divine	44
Tony Stark / Iron Man	Marc-Anthony Bullock	45
Gen. Aleksander Lukin (<i>the Red Skull shares his body</i>)	Mads Mikkelsen	61
Johann Schmidt / The Red Skull (<i>his true face, seen inside minds and time</i>)	Hugo Weaving	66
Brock Rumlow / Crossbones	Frank Grillo	61
Sinthea Schmidt / Sin (<i>the Red Skull's daughter</i>)	Fresh casting (<i>never played by a real actor</i>)	–
Dr. Johann Fennhoff / Doctor Faustus	Fresh casting (<i>the Peggy Carter TV version is not 616</i>)	–
Arnim Zola	Toby Jones	60
Peggy Carter (1944, inside Steve's time-slip)	Hayley Atwell	44
Cpl. Dum Dum Dugan (1944)	Neal McDonough	61
Nick Fury (<i>underground</i>)	Samuel L. Jackson	78
Victor von Doom (<i>post-credit</i>)	Robert Downey Jr.	61

In memoriam: Stan Lee (1922–2018). A "Stan Lee Memorial Courthouse" plaque is behind the podium where Steve is shot. It's the saga's quiet tribute. (Real history: Stan Lee did write Captain America, starting with Tales of Suspense #59, 1964.)

3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

Field	Entry
Primary comic(s) adapted	" <i>The Death of Captain America</i> ", <i>Captain America</i> vol. 5 #25–42 (2007–08), Ed Brubaker & Steve Epting: Steve Rogers is shot on the courthouse steps. Crossbones fires from a sniper's nest, and Sharon Carter , hypnotized by Doctor Faustus , fires the killing shots at close range. The Red Skull (in Lukin's body), Sin , Zola and Faustus try to take America apart. Tony Stark receives Steve's last letter and gives the shield to Bucky (#34), who becomes the new Captain America. <i>Captain America: Reborn</i> #1–6 (2009–10), Brubaker & Bryan Hitch: Sharon's gun was built on Doctor Doom's technology. It didn't kill Steve. It unstuck him in time. Steve relives his own life , from WWII onward, and fights his way back. The Skull tries to take Steve's body for himself , and Sharon destroys him.
Supporting comics	<i>Captain America</i> #25 (2007, the "Stan Lee" courthouse is the saga's own tribute) · <i>Fallen Son: The Death of Captain America</i> #1–5 (2007): the world mourns, and Tony at Steve's grave · <i>Captain America</i> vol. 5 #34 (2008, Bucky's first mission as Cap) · <i>Captain America</i> #107 (1969, Doctor Faustus) · <i>Captain America</i> #290 (1984, Sin) · <i>Captain America</i> #208 (1977, Arnim Zola) · <i>Reborn</i> #6 (2010): Steve tells Bucky to keep the shield
Nerf check	✅ Steve is not killed by being outfought. He's shot in the back by the woman he loves, under mind control , and even then the bullet is Doom-level technology . Steve fights the Red Skull from inside his own body and wins . Bucky carries the shield at full strength , with his cybernetic arm and Winter Soldier training .

3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

Field	Entry
Overall accuracy score	96%. <i>The Death of Captain America</i> and <i>Reborn</i> are adapted beat for beat, pressed into one film.

Straight from the page:

- **Steve Rogers surrenders** to face federal charges, and **is shot on the courthouse steps** (#25).
- **Crossbones** is the sniper; **Sharon Carter**, under **Doctor Faustus's** conditioning, fires the last shots **without knowing she's doing it** (#25–26).
- **Steve dies** (as far as the world knows). **The funeral**, the mourning, and **Tony at the grave** (*Fallen Son* #5).
- Steve's **letter** to Tony asks him to **keep Bucky safe**. Tony **gives Bucky the shield**, and **Bucky becomes Captain America** (#33–34).
- **The Red Skull** is sharing **Lukin's body**, and uses **Sin, Crossbones, Zola and Faustus** to attack America **from inside** (#25–42).
- **Sharon's gun** was built from **Doom's technology**. Steve was **frozen outside time**, not killed (*Reborn* #1).
- **Steve relives his own life**, is **aware of it**, and **changes nothing**, because he **mustn't** (*Reborn* #2–4).
- **The Skull puts his mind into Steve's body**. Steve **fights him from inside** (*Reborn* #5).

- **The Skull ends up in a Zola robot body**, and **Sharon destroys it** (*Reborn* #6).
- **Steve tells Bucky to keep the shield** (*Reborn* #6).

Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

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| Steve surrenders over **exposing the Illuminati's classified operations**, not over the Superhuman Registration Act | MCU continuity. **The Registration fight ended in *Civil War* (2016)**; the 2026–27 fight is over the Illuminati. The **courthouse and the shooting** are the same. |

| **Sharon's pregnancy** (616: she's pregnant, and loses the baby in *Reborn*) is **kept, but told quietly**: she tells Steve after he's back. **The baby is lost in the off-screen gap, and the film says so.** | 616 accurate, and handled with care at PG-13 |

| **Doom sells the time technology to the Skull directly**, not through Norman Osborn's Cabal | **Norman Osborn isn't in play** in the MCU. Doom's reason is his own: he wants **data on surviving outside time** (see the post-credit scene). |

| The two comics' story is **pressed into one film** | Runtime. The 616 gap between Steve's death and *Reborn* was **2 years (2007–09)**; in the MCU it's **12 weeks.** |

POWERS & ABILITIES

Character	616 powers & abilities	Shown in this film	Held back (why)	Match
Captain America (Steve)	Peak human strength, speed, stamina, reflexes; the best hand-to-hand fighter and tactician alive; the indestructible shield	All of it, across the whole film : WWII, the time-slip, and the fight inside his own mind against the Skull	—	✓ 100%
Captain America (Bucky)	Peak human; cybernetic arm (enhanced strength, EMP); a master sniper, assassin and spy ; the shield plus a gun and a knife (616 Bucky-Cap carries both)	All of it: Bucky-Cap fights differently from Steve , and the film shows why	—	✓ 100%
The Falcon	Flight harness; telepathic link with Redwing ; aerial combat	All of it	—	✓ 100%
Black Widow	Red Room; Widow's Bite ; master spy	All of it	—	✓ 100%
The Red Skull	Genius strategist, mind in a borrowed body ; a master of propaganda	Runs the war from inside Lukin , then inside Steve	—	✓ 100%
Crossbones	Brutal hand-to-hand fighter; expert sniper	The shot, and a fight with Bucky	—	✓ 100%
Sin	Trained killer	All of it	—	✓ 100%
Doctor Faustus	A master psychiatrist and hypnotist	Conditions Sharon	—	✓ 100%
Arnim Zola	A genius bio-fanatic ; his mind lives in robot bodies with a face on the chest	The robot bodies	—	✓ 100%

4. STORY

Field	Entry
Logline	The man who exposed the Illuminati is shot on the courthouse steps. The world buries Captain America; Bucky Barnes picks up the shield; and Steve Rogers is still alive, trapped somewhere in his own past.
Theme	What does Captain America mean without Steve Rogers?
Villain / antagonist	THE RED SKULL (main); Sin, Crossbones, Arnim Zola, Doctor Faustus

What the movie is about

ACT ONE: THE STEPS

- **Monday, November 16, 2026.** Steve has **exposed the Illuminati**, and **he broke the law to do it**. He **surrenders** to face charges, because **he believes nobody is above the law, including him**.
- **9:42 a.m.**, the steps of the federal courthouse in Lower Manhattan. **A shot from a rooftop** (Crossbones). Steve **pushes Sharon out of the way**. Then **Sharon, eyes blank, fires three more times**.
- **Steve Rogers is pronounced dead at 10:17 a.m.**
- **The funeral at Arlington.** Tony, alone at the grave after everyone's gone: *"It wasn't worth it. None of it was worth it."*
- **Steve's letter:** *"Look after Bucky. And if the shield has to go on... give it to him."*

ACT TWO: THE NEW CAPTAIN AMERICA

- **Bucky refuses.** Tony: *"He asked for you. I'm just the mailman."*
- **Bucky's first mission as Captain America**, with **a pistol on his hip** (616): *"I'm not Steve. I never will be."*
- **The Skull's plan:** **Sin** and **Crossbones** create chaos in American cities; **Faustus** conditions agents; **the Kronas Corporation** (Lukin's) buys up America's debt.
- **Sharon**, free of Faustus, finds out **the gun wasn't a gun**. It was **Doom's technology**. *"He's not dead. He's stuck."*

ACT THREE: REBORN

- **Steve, unstuck in time**, relives his life: **Project: Rebirth**, **Bucky in 1944**, **Peggy**, **the Howling Commandos**, and **the ice**, over and over. **He knows it's happening. He can't change anything.**
 - **The Skull's real plan** is to **pull Steve back into the present and take his body**.
 - **The Skull does it.** For one terrible scene **Steve's face smiles the Skull's smile** in front of the whole nation.
 - **Inside Steve's mind**, on a **1944 battlefield**, **Steve beats the Skull** (Hugo Weaving) with his bare hands.
 - **The Skull flees into a Zola robot body**, and **Sharon destroys it**.
 - **Steve is back.** Bucky holds out the shield. **Steve:** *"You keep it, Buck. Right now the country needs you."*
 - **The last scene:** Steve, in plain clothes, looks at **the two Earths in the sky** and calls **Maria Hill**. *"The Illuminati. I want every one of them found."*
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5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

Field	Entry
When it's set	Monday, November 16, 2026 (the shooting, 9:42 a.m.) → Saturday, February 6, 2027 . Flashbacks through Steve's time-slip: 1940–1945 and 2011–2026 .
Where it's set	New York City (the federal courthouse, Brooklyn) · Arlington National Cemetery · Washington, D.C. · the Kronas tower, Moscow · 1944 Europe (the time-slip)
Relative to other films	It follows <i>World War Hulk</i> (which ends September 19, 2026). It sets up <i>Avengers: Time Runs Out</i> , where Steve leads the hunt for the Illuminati.

6. WORLD-BUILDING

The film's own world

- **Bucky Barnes is Captain America.** Steve is alive, **full power, no shield**, and **angrier than he's ever been**.
- **The Red Skull is destroyed** (for now).
- **Sin** escapes.

World-building for the wider MCU

Seed	How it appears	Payoff
Bucky as Cap	He keeps the shield	<i>Time Runs Out</i>
Steve without the shield	"Right now the country needs you"	On 616 Steve takes back the shield after <i>Fear Itself</i> (2011). Phase 6.
Sin	She gets away	Phase 6

Setting up the Big Bad (THE SECRET WARS SAGA)

Seed	How it appears	What it means
Doom's time technology	Inside the gun	Doom is studying how to survive outside time , which is how he'll survive the end of everything
The Illuminati hunt	Steve's call to Maria Hill	<i>Avengers: Time Runs Out</i>

7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

Field	Entry
Mid-credit scene	✓ "THE SHIELD." Bucky, alone in Avengers Mansion, tries to throw the shield the way Steve does . It misses and smashes a vase . Sam, from the doorway: <i>"...We'll work on it."</i>
Post-credit scene	✓ "DATA." Castle Doom, Latveria. A Doombot hands Doom a smoking wreck: the gun's firing mechanism. Doom reads the data on a screen: Steve's 12 weeks outside time . DOOM: <i>"Twelve weeks outside time. And the man came back... himself."</i> He looks up at the two Earths in the sky . DOOM: <i>"Then it can be done."</i> CUT TO BLACK. "CAPTAIN AMERICA WILL RETURN."
Secret shoot codenames	Mid-credit: "PRACTICE ROUND." Post-credit: "RECEIPTS."

CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline